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2D Project Proposal: Deadbeam

OVERVIEW

Deadbeam is a 2D top-down survival game. The game is set inside a dark, abandoned hospital during a blackout caused by the severe rainstorm outside. The goal is to survive and restore three generators to turn on the power for the lights fully and exit the hospital. The player is equipped with only a flashlight with limited batteries and must collect more batteries along the way to recharge it. The flashlight has limited batteries, so it cannot be turned on at all times. The player heavily relies on the flashlight to navigate in the darkness, but the light beam from the flashlight also attracts shadow creatures, causing them to attack the player. The shadow creatures become fully frozen or stuck in place in the direct light of the flashlight. The player cannot attack or damage the shadow creatures. The hospital consists of hallways that are set up like a maze with blocking objects and batteries in random places. The game progressively gets more difficult as the player restores each generator. More creatures will spawn and be attracted by the flashlight, and fewer batteries will be available along the hallways. The player has to carefully decide when to use the flashlight, navigate the confusing hallways, restore the three generators, and escape the hospital alive.

CONTROLS

WASD: Player movement through the hospital.
Mouse: Aim the flashlight centered on the player.
F / Left click: Turn flashlight on/off.
E: Interact with batteries and generators.

Art Assets:

- Top-down player and shadow creature sprites.
- Hospital facility with walls, floors, boxes, batteries, generators, and doors.

- Flashlight and lighting effects.
- UI components include the player's HP, battery life, and generator progress.

Audio Assets:

- Player damage sound
- Player and shadow creatures' footsteps
- Player interaction with batteries and generators
- Flashlight turn on/ off click
- Shadow creatures waking up sound
- Shadow creatures freezing sound when hit by flashlight
- Hospital ambient sounds of lightning and storms
- Background eerie music

CONCERNS

- Balance of being able to make out the layout of the hallways and complete blackout.
- Asset designs that may be too confusing with minimal instructions.
- Shadow creatures' interaction with walls and objects.
- Balance of having enough batteries but still being challenging.

INSPIRATION

This game is inspired by Darkwood and Resident Evil without the combat mechanics. I enjoyed these two games and wanted to use them as my inspiration while making it my own game. I don't intend for this game to be a full horror game, in the sense that it has jump scares or is unplayable for those scared of typical horror games.